

Mahla Shourian

Department of Economics, University of Oklahoma
308 Cate Center Drive, Room 326, Norman, OK 73072

(405) 930-7819 | mahla.shourian@ou.edu | mahla-shourian.github.io | [LinkedIn](#)

EDUCATION

- 2027** (Expected) **Ph.D. in Economics**, University of Oklahoma, Norman, OK
Dissertation: *The Economics of the Family: Essays on Wages, Fertility, and Divorce*
Committee: Pallab Ghosh (Chair), Firat Demir, Tyler Ransom, Joan Hamory, Nghiem Q. Huynh
- 2017 M.A. in Development Economics, Allameh Tabataba'i University, Tehran, Iran
Thesis: *Gender Wage Gap, Glass Ceiling, and Sticky Floor in Iran's Labor Market*
- 2014 B.A. in Commercial Economics, Allameh Tabataba'i University, Tehran, Iran

RESEARCH FIELDS

- Primary Labor Economics; Economics of Gender and the Family
- Secondary Public Economics; Health Economics; Demographic Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

When the Marriage Market Fails: How Changes in Relative Wages Shape Childbearing Decisions.

Using IPUMS Census and ACS microdata and a Bartik-style shift-share instrument for potential wages, I estimate how a rising female-to-male wage ratio affects U.S. fertility. A 10% increase in the ratio lowers the share of women with a child by 4 percentage points, reduces completed fertility by 0.7 children, and delays first birth by three years, through marriage, specialization breakdown, and bargaining channels.

PUBLICATIONS

- “Power of Public Health Advice: Effectiveness and Spillover Effects of Federal Vaccine Recommendations” (with Junying Zhao, Ahmed El Fatmaoui, Pallab Ghosh, and Bethanie Lor). *Public Health in Practice*, 2025. doi.org/10.1016/j.puhip.2025.100667

WORKING PAPERS

- “[When the Marriage Market Fails: How Changes in Relative Wages Shape Childbearing Decisions](#)” (Job Market Paper).
- “[The Relative Wage and Marriage after 2010: A Comment on Shenhav \(2021\)](#)” (with Pallab Ghosh). Under review at *Review of Economics and Statistics*.
- “[Children Who Witness: Early-Life Exposure to Unilateral Divorce Laws and Intimate Partner Violence in Adulthood](#)” (with Pallab Ghosh).
- “[A Slow Burn: The Opioid Epidemic and the Rise in Teen Fertility](#)” (with Pallab Ghosh).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- “Educated and Alone? How Gender Imbalances in Higher Education Shape the Marriage Market.”
- “From Mother to Daughter: Policy Influences on Teenage Pregnancy.”

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026	ASSA Annual Meeting (Philadelphia, PA); WEAI 101st Conference (Denver, CO)
2025	SEA 95th Annual Meeting (Tampa, FL); WEAI 100th Conference (San Francisco, CA)
2024	SEA 94th Annual Meeting (Washington, D.C.); WEAI 99th Annual Conference (Seattle, WA); MEA 88th Annual Meeting (Chicago, IL); MVEA Annual Conference (Kansas City, MO)

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

- CSWEP Mentoring Workshop Travel Grant (2025)
- DFCAS Dissertation Completion Fellowship, University of Oklahoma (2025)
- Chong Liew Summer Research Award, University of Oklahoma (2024, 2025)
- Robberson Research and Travel Grant, University of Oklahoma (2023, 2024, 2025)
- GSS Research and Conference Grants, University of Oklahoma (2023, 2024, 2025)

RESTRICTED DATA AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2024–Present	Approved BLS access to restricted-use NLSY79 and NLSY79-CYA data via a secure enclave; disclosure-review and confidentiality training completed.
2022–2023	Research Assistant (Economics and Public Health), University of Oklahoma
2014–2017	Research Assistant, Allameh Tabataba'i University

TEACHING

Instructor of Record, in person, University of Oklahoma:

- Elements of Statistics (ECON 2843): Fall 2026
- Principles of Economics–Micro (ECON 1123): Spring 2027

Instructor of Record, online, University of Oklahoma:

- Elements of Statistics (ECON 2843): Summer 2023, Fall 2023, Summer 2024, Fall 2024, Summer 2025
- Principles of Economics–Micro (ECON 1123): Summer 2023

Teaching Assistant / Guest Lecturer: Labor Economics I (Ph.D.), Econometrics II (Ph.D.), Intermediate Microeconomic Theory, Introduction to Applied Econometrics, Labor Problems, and the Economics of Discrimination.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2025	Referee, <i>The Economic and Labour Relations Review</i>
2025	Member, Economics Faculty Search Committee, University of Oklahoma

SKILLS

Software	Stata, R, Julia, MATLAB, L ^A T _E X, Git
Languages	English (fluent); Persian (native)

REFERENCES

Pallab Ghosh (Chair)

Associate Professor of Economics
University of Oklahoma
pallab.ghosh@ou.edu

Tyler Ransom

Associate Professor of Economics
University of Oklahoma
ransom@ou.edu

Nghiem Q. Huynh

Assistant Professor of Economics
University of Oklahoma
nqh@ou.edu

Firat Demir

Interim Chair; David L. Boren Professor
University of Oklahoma
fdemir@ou.edu

Joan Hamory

Associate Professor of Economics
University of Oklahoma
jhamory@ou.edu

Samantha R. Johnson (Teaching)

Lecturer in Economics
University of Oklahoma
samrjohnson@ou.edu